

Will/shall 1

A

We use **I'll** (= **I will**) when we've just decided to do something. When we say 'I'll do something', we announce our decision:

- ☐ Oh, I've left the door open. **I'll go** and shut it.
- ☐ 'What would you like to drink?' **I'll have** an orange juice, please.'
- ☐ 'Did you phone Lucy?' 'Oh no, I forgot. **I'll phone** her now.'

You cannot use the *present simple* (**I do / I go** etc.) in these sentences:

- ☐ **I'll go** and shut the door. (*not I go and shut*)

We often use **I think I'll ...** and **I don't think I'll ...**:

- ☐ I feel a bit hungry. **I think I'll have** something to eat.
- ☐ **I don't think I'll go** out tonight. I'm too tired.

In spoken English the negative of **will** is usually **won't** (= **will not**):

- ☐ I can see you're busy, so **I won't stay** long.

B

Do *not* use **will** to talk about what you decided before (see Units 19–20):

- ☐ **I'm going** on holiday next Saturday. (*not I'll go*)
- ☐ **Are you working** tomorrow? (*not Will you work*)

C

We often use **will** in these situations:

Offering to do something

- ☐ That bag looks heavy. **I'll help** you with it. (*not I help*)

Agreeing to do something

- ☐ A: Can you give Tim this book?
- ☐ B: Sure, **I'll give** it to him when I see him this afternoon.

Promising to do something

- ☐ Thanks for lending me the money. **I'll pay** you back on Friday.
- ☐ **I won't tell** anyone what happened. I promise.

Asking somebody to do something (Will you ... ?)

- ☐ **Will you** please turn the music down? I'm trying to concentrate.

You can use **won't** to say that somebody refuses to do something:

- ☐ I've tried to give her advice, but she **won't listen**.
- ☐ The car **won't start**. (= the car 'refuses' to start)



D

Shall I ... ? Shall we ... ?

Shall is used mostly in the questions **shall I ... ? / shall we ... ?**

We use **shall I ... ? / shall we ... ?** to ask somebody's opinion (especially in offers or suggestions):

- ☐ **Shall I** open the window? (= Do you want me to open the window?)
- ☐ I've got no money. What **shall I** do? (= What do you suggest?)
- ☐ '**Shall we** go?' 'Just a minute. I'm not ready yet.'
- ☐ 'Where **shall we** have lunch?' 'Let's go to Marino's.'

Compare **shall I ... ?** and **will you ... ?**:

- ☐ **Shall I** shut the door? (= Do you want me to shut it?)
- ☐ **Will you** shut the door? (= I want you to shut it)

Exercises

21.1 Complete the sentences with **I'll** + a suitable verb.

- I'm too tired to walk home. I think I'll take a taxi.
- 'It's cold in this room.' 'Is it?' on the heating then.'
- 'Bye! Have a nice holiday!' 'Thanks. you a postcard.'
- 'Shall I do the washing-up?' 'No, it's all right. it later.'
- 'I don't know how to shut down this computer.' 'OK, you.'
- 'Would you like tea or coffee?' '..... coffee, please.'
- 'Are you coming with us?' 'No, I think here.'
- Thanks for lending me the money. it back as soon as possible, OK?
- A: I know you're busy, but can you finish this report this afternoon?
B: Well,, but I can't promise.

21.2 Read the situations and write sentences with **I think I'll ...** or **I don't think I'll ...**.

- It's a bit cold. The window is open and you decide to close it. You say:
I think I'll close the window.
- You are feeling tired and it's getting late. You decide to go to bed. You say:
I think
- A friend of yours offers you a lift in his car, but you decide to walk. You say:
Thank you, but
- You were going to have lunch. Now you decide that you don't want to eat anything. You say:
I don't think
- You planned to go swimming. Now you decide that you don't want to go. You say:
.....

21.3 Which is correct? (If necessary, study Units 19–20 first.)

- 'Did you phone Lucy?' 'Oh no, I forgot. +phone / I'll phone her now.' (I'll phone is correct)
- I can't meet you tomorrow. I'm playing / +I'll play tennis. (I'm playing is correct)
- I meet / I'll meet you outside the hotel in half an hour, OK? 'Yes, that's fine.'
- 'I need some money.' 'OK, I'm lending / I'll lend you some. How much do you need?'
- I'm having / I'll have a party next Saturday. I hope you can come.
- 'Remember to get a newspaper when you go out.' 'OK, I don't forget / I won't forget.'
- What time does your train leave / will your train leave tomorrow?
- I asked Sue what happened, but she doesn't tell / won't tell me.
- 'Are you doing / Will you do anything tomorrow evening?' 'No, I'm free. Why?'
- I don't want to go out alone. Do you come / Will you come with me?

21.4 What do you say in these situations? Write sentences with **shall I ... ?** or **shall we ... ?**

- You and a friend want to do something this evening, but you don't know what.
You ask your friend: What shall we do this evening?
- You try on a jacket in a shop. You are not sure whether to buy it or not.
You ask a friend for advice: it?
- It's Helen's birthday next week. You want to give her a present, but you don't know what.
You ask a friend for advice:
What
- You and a friend are going on holiday together, but you have to decide where.
You ask him/her:
- You and a friend are going out. You have to decide whether to go by car or to walk.
You ask him/her: or
- Your friend wants you to come and see her. You don't know what time to come.
You ask her:

Will/shall 2

A

We do not use **will** to say what somebody has already arranged or decided to do:

- ☐ Diane **is working** next week. (*not* Diane will work)
 - ☐ **Are you going to watch** anything on TV this evening? (*not* Will you watch)
- For '**is working**' and '**Are you going to ... ?**', see Units 19–20.

But often, when we talk about the future, we are *not* talking about what somebody has decided to do. For example:

Kate is doing an exam next week. Chris and Joe are talking about it.

Do you think Kate **will pass** the exam?

CHRIS

Yes, she'll **pass** easily.



JOE

She'll pass does *not* mean 'she has decided to pass'. Joe is saying what he knows or believes will happen.

He is *predicting* the future.

When we predict a future happening or situation, we use **will/won't**.

Some more examples:

- ☐ They've been away a long time. When they return, they'll **find** a lot of changes here.
- ☐ 'Where **will** you **be** this time next year?' 'I'll **be** in Japan.'
- ☐ That plate is hot. If you touch it, you'll **burn** yourself.
- ☐ Tom **won't pass** the exam. He hasn't studied hard enough.
- ☐ Anna looks completely different now. You **won't recognise** her.
- ☐ When **will** you **get** your exam results?

B

We often use **will** ('ll) with:

probably

(I'm) **sure**

(I) **think**

(I) **don't think**

I **wonder**

- ☐ I'll **probably** be home late tonight.
- ☐ Don't worry about the exam. I'm **sure** you'll pass.
- ☐ Do you **think** Sarah **will** like the present we bought her?
- ☐ I **don't think** the exam **will** be very difficult.
- ☐ I **wonder** what **will** happen.

After **I hope**, we generally use the present (**will** is also possible):

- ☐ I hope Kate **passes** the exam. (*or* I hope Kate **will pass** ...)
- ☐ I hope it **doesn't rain** tomorrow.

C

Generally we use **will** to talk about *the future*, but sometimes we use **will** to talk about *now*. For example:

- ☐ Don't phone Ann now. She'll **be** busy. (= she'll be busy *now*)

D

I shall ... / we shall ...

Normally we use **shall** only with **I** and **we**. You can say:

I shall or **I will** (I'll) **we shall** or **we will** (we'll)

- ☐ I **shall** be late this evening. (*or* I **will** be)
- ☐ **We shall** probably go to France in June. (*or* We **will** probably go)

In spoken English we normally use **I'll** and **we'll**:

- ☐ **We'll** probably go to France.

The negative of **shall** is **shall not** or **shan't**:

- ☐ I **shan't** be here tomorrow. (*or* I **won't** be)

Do not use **shall** with **he/she/it/you/they**:

- ☐ She **will** be very angry. (*not* She shall be)

Exercises

22.1 Which form of the verb is better in these sentences? The verbs are underlined.

- 1 Diane isn't free on Saturday. She'll work / She's working. (She's working is correct)
- 2 I'll go / I'm going to a party tomorrow night. Would you like to come too?
- 3 I think Amy will get / is getting the job. She has a lot of experience.
- 4 I can't meet you this evening. A friend of mine will come / is coming to see me.
- 5 A: Have you decided where to go for your holidays?
B: Yes, we'll go / we're going to Italy.
- 6 Don't be afraid of the dog. It won't hurt / It isn't hurting you.

22.2 Put in **will ('ll)** or **won't**.

- 1 Can you wait for me? I won't be long.
- 2 Don't ask Amanda for advice. She know what to do.
- 3 I'm glad you're coming to see us next week. It be good to see you again.
- 4 I'm sorry about what happened yesterday. It happen again.
- 5 You don't need to take an umbrella with you. I don't think it rain.
- 6 I've got some incredible news! You believe it.

22.3 Complete the sentences using **will ('ll)**. Choose from the following:

it / be	she / come	you / get	you / like
people / live	it / look	we / meet	you / pass

- 1 Don't worry about your exam. I'm sure you'll pass.
- 2 Why don't you try on this jacket? nice on you.
- 3 You must meet Daniel sometime. I think him.
- 4 It's raining. Don't go out. wet.
- 5 Do you think longer in the future?
- 6 Bye! I'm sure again before long.
- 7 I've invited Anna to the party, but I don't think
- 8 It takes me an hour to get to work at the moment, but when the new road is finished, much quicker.

22.4 Write questions using **do you think ... will ... ?** + the following:

be back	cost	end	get married	happen	like	rain
---------	------	-----	-------------	--------	-----------------	------

- 1 I've bought this picture for Karen. Do you think she'll like it ?
- 2 The weather doesn't look very good. Do you ?
- 3 The meeting is still going on. When do you ?
- 4 My car needs to be repaired. How much ?
- 5 Sally and David are in love. Do ?
- 6 'I'm going out now.' 'OK. What time ?'
- 7 The future situation is uncertain. What ?

22.5 Where do you think you will be at these times? Write true sentences about yourself. Use:
I'll be ... or I'll probably be ... or I don't know where I'll be

- 1 (next Monday evening at 7.45) I'll be at home.
or I'll probably be at home.
or I don't know where I'll be.
- 2 (at 5 o'clock tomorrow morning)
- 3 (at 10.30 tomorrow morning)
- 4 (next Saturday afternoon at 4.15)
- 5 (this time next year)

I will and I'm going to

A

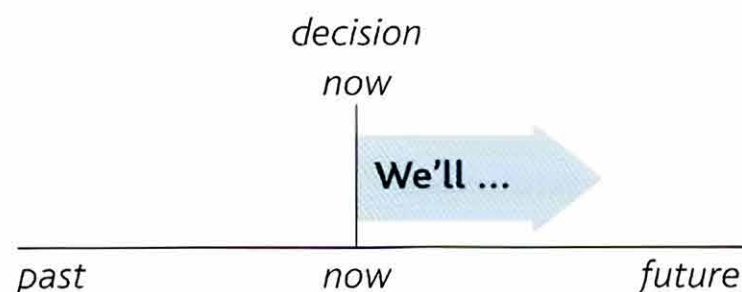
Future actions

Study the difference between **will** and **(be) going to**:

Sarah is talking to Helen:



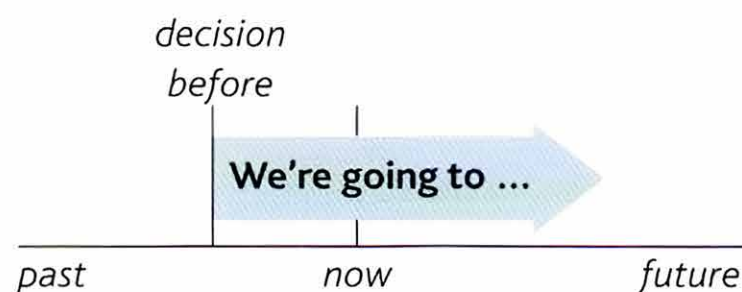
will ('ll): We use **will** to announce a new decision. The party is a new idea.



Later that day, Helen meets Dan:



(be) going to: We use **(be) going to** when we have *already decided* to do something. Helen had already decided to invite lots of people *before* she spoke to Dan.



Compare:

- ☐ 'Gary phoned while you were out.' 'OK. I'll call him back.'
- ☐ 'Gary **phoned** while you were out.' 'Yes, I know. I'm going to call him back.'
- ☐ 'Anna is in hospital.' 'Oh really? I didn't know. I'll go and visit her.'
- ☐ 'Anna is in hospital.' 'Yes, I know. I'm going to visit her this evening.'

B

Future happenings and situations (predicting the future)

We use both **will** and **going to** to predict future happenings and situations. So you can say:

- ☐ I think **the weather will be** nice later. *or*
I think **the weather is going to be** nice later.
- ☐ Those shoes are well-made. **They'll last** a long time. *or*
Those shoes are well-made. **They're going to last** a long time.

When we say something **is going to** happen, we know this from the situation *now*. What is happening *now* shows that something **is going to** happen in the future. For example:

- ☐ Look at those black clouds. **It's going to rain.** (*not* It will rain)
(We can see that it **is going to rain** from the clouds that are in the sky *now*.)
- ☐ I feel terrible. I think **I'm going to be** sick. (*not* I think I'll be sick)
(I think **I'm going to be** sick because I feel terrible *now*.)

Do not use **will** in this type of situation.

23.1 Complete the sentences using **will ('ll)** or **going to**.

- 1 A: Why are you turning on the TV?
B: I'm going to watch the news. (I / watch)
- 2 A: Oh, I've just realised. I haven't got any money.
B: Haven't you? Well, don't worry. _____ you some. (I / lend)
- 3 A: I've got a headache.
B: Have you? Wait a second and _____ an aspirin for you. (I / get)
- 4 A: Why are you filling that bucket with water?
B: _____ the car. (I / wash)
- 5 A: I've decided to repaint this room.
B: Oh, have you? What colour _____ it? (you / paint)
- 6 A: Where are you going? Are you going shopping?
B: Yes, _____ some things for dinner. (I / buy)
- 7 A: I don't know how to use the washing machine.
B: It's easy. _____ you. (I / show)
- 8 A: What would you like to eat?
B: _____ a pizza, please. (I / have)
- 9 A: Did you call Lisa?
B: Oh, no. I completely forgot. _____ her now. (I / call)
- 10 A: Has Dan decided what to do when he leaves school?
B: Yes. Everything is planned. _____ a holiday for a few weeks.
(he / have) Then _____ a management training course. (he / do)

23.2 Read the situations and complete the sentences using **will ('ll)** or **going to**.

- 1 The phone rings and you answer. Somebody wants to speak to John.
CALLER: Hello. Can I speak to John, please?
YOU: Just a moment. I'll get him. (I / get)
- 2 It's a nice day, so you have decided to take a walk. Just before you go, you tell your friend.
YOU: The weather's too nice to stay in. _____ a walk. (I / take)
FRIEND: Good idea! I think _____ you. (I / join)
- 3 Your friend is worried because she has lost her driving licence.
YOU: Don't worry. I'm sure _____ it. (you / find)
FRIEND: I hope so.
- 4 There was a job advertised in the paper recently. At first you were interested, but then you decided not to apply.
FRIEND: Have you decided what to do about that job you were interested in?
YOU: Yes, _____ for it. (I / not / apply)
- 5 You and a friend are stuck in traffic. You have to be in a meeting in five minutes and you need at least another 20 minutes to get there.
YOU: The meeting begins in five minutes. _____ . (we / be late)
- 6 Ann and Sam are staying at a hotel. Their room is in very bad condition, especially the ceiling.
ANN: The ceiling doesn't look very safe, does it?
SAM: No, it looks as if _____ . (it / fall down)
- 7 Paul has to go to the airport to catch a plane tomorrow morning.
PAUL: Kate, I need somebody to take me to the airport tomorrow morning.
KATE: That's no problem. _____ you. (I / take) What time is your flight?
PAUL: 10.30.
KATE: OK, _____ you up at your house at about 8 o'clock then. (I / pick)
Later that day, Joe offers to take Paul to the airport.
JOE: Paul, do you want me to take you to the airport?
PAUL: No thanks, Joe. _____ me. (Kate / take)